Jackman Wheels Ambassador Program

Founder brief · 7 October 2026 · Austin Fitzgerald

Purpose of this document: to get three decisions made so the program can launch on 1 January 2027. Full operating detail sits in the program design document; this is the short version.

The problem I am trying to solve

We are asking people to spend real money on a wheel they have never seen on a truck like theirs.

- **We have almost no proof the product exists in the wild.** No library of real installs, on real trucks, shot properly. Every brand we compete with has hundreds of these.
- **Our own audience is small.** The Instagram account started this quarter at 760 followers. Paid social can buy reach, but it cannot buy credibility, and cold traffic to an unproven brand converts badly.
- **Credibility in this category is borrowed, not bought.** Buyers decide by looking at builds they admire. We need to be on those builds.

An ambassador program solves all three at once, and it is the cheapest way to do it.

What I am proposing

Sign eight ambassadors to a one-year sponsorship for 2027, reviewed in October 2027 to decide on 2028.

Five mechanics:

Term	Signature through 31 December 2027. One shared renewal date
Content	One post per month, in their own voice. We never write the caption
Events	Display their vehicle at Southern California shows — one ambassador per show
Announcements	Up to six times a year they push a launch or an offer to their audience
Compensation	Tiered: some receive a set of wheels, some a deep discount. Each gets a discount code to hand out

The year-long term is deliberate. Monthly one-off posts are forgettable; a year of someone genuinely running our wheels is a track record.

Who

I scanned Instagram directly and built a vetted roster. Not a bought list.

- **59 accounts** reviewed individually — follower count, location, platform, existing sponsors, whether their content actually shows wheels
- Scored on one model and sequenced into waves
- **Eight proposed for launch**, with four conversations already underway

The opening roster

Tier	Who	Why
Founding	@yotawolf89	Working photographer, San Diego. Highest-scoring account of all 59
Founding	@ghostpro.la	Professional photographer, Los Angeles, 2026 Tacoma
Founding	@22protaco	Already shoots wheel detail unprompted. Receptive
Founding	@campygilmore	Anchor of the Southern California scene. Acquiring a second business account
Ambassador	@keepitdirty_offroad	Ford Raptor, runs organised group runs
Ambassador	@groovyrunner.gx	Two vehicles, two fitments, one agreement
Ambassador	@zr2chris22	Best Chevrolet account available. Runs a wheeling group
Ambassador	@chance.the.raptr	Bronco Raptor — a platform almost nobody makes wheels for yet

Two of the eight are professional photographers. That is deliberate. They solve the content problem and the reach problem in a single agreement, and we would otherwise be paying a studio for the same images with none of the audience attached.

Start at eight, not fifteen. Marketing is one person. A program that works at eight can grow; one that collapses at fifteen cannot be restarted, because these people all know each other.

What it costs

The structure is settled. The numbers need three inputs from you.

Line	Basis	2027 estimate
Founding tier — 4 sets of wheels	4 ambassadors × 5 wheels × COGS	**$_____**
Ambassador tier — discounted sets	4 ambassadors × forgone margin	**$_____**
Shipping and fitment	8 installs	**$_____**
Event support	~4 shows — stipend, passes, insurance	**$_____**
Photography contract	One ambassador is a professional and has quoted	**$_____**
	Total program	**$_____**

Three numbers I need from you to complete this:

1. Wheel COGS per set
2. What we mean by "deep discount" as a percentage
3. A budget ceiling for 2027

With those I can model the program at eight, twelve and fifteen ambassadors in an afternoon.

Worth stating plainly: a free set is not free. It is cost of goods, plus shipping, plus the margin we give up. But compared with the alternative — buying the same photography outright and buying the same reach through ads — it is substantially cheaper, and the ads do not come with a person vouching for us.

Three decisions I need from this meeting

1. The discount codes versus the dealer channel. This is the one that genuinely needs founder sign-off. We have 25 dealers in progress, and their reason to stock us is margin. If eight ambassadors hand out codes that undercut dealer pricing, we are competing with the people we are asking to carry inventory — and they find out, because customers show them the code.

My recommendation: **keep the friend code at 10–15%**, which sits below typical dealer margin, so a dealer can still compete on price and service. The longer-term answer is making codes redeemable at dealers too, which turns ambassadors into dealer traffic instead of dealer competition.

2. Free wheels, or discount only? My recommendation: free sets for the four Founding ambassadors, deep discount for the rest. The four receiving sets are the ones delivering photography and event presence — things we would otherwise purchase.

3. The budget ceiling. Without a number, "we will review each one individually" has no limit. A ceiling turns every individual negotiation into a straightforward yes or no.

What we get back, and how we will judge it

Tracked per ambassador, every month: code redemptions and revenue, posts delivered against the twelve committed, events attended, and content assets received.

One expectation I want to set now, before anyone asks in March.

Direct revenue through discount codes will probably not cover the cost of the wheels in year one. That is normal for a first-year program, and it is not what we are buying.

Year one buys proof. A library of real installs we own and can use in every ad, email and dealer conversation. A visible roster that makes the brand look established. Eight credible people whose audiences have now seen our wheels on a truck they respect.

Judge 2027 on assets and credibility. Judge 2028 on revenue.

Timeline

October	Decisions above. Confirm fitment availability for each ambassador's truck
Late October	Agreement drafted. Contact the two photographers
November	Close the Founding tier. Ship wheels and install
November–December	**The install content push** — this is where the asset library gets built
December	Close the Ambassador tier. Build the 2027 event calendar
1 January 2027	Program live, with content already in hand

The November and December work is the part that matters most. If we arrive at January with eight signatures and no photography, we have a roster and nothing to show for it.

The honest risks

Risk	Mitigation
Dealer resentment over codes	Decision 1 above. Settle it before any code is issued

Risk	Mitigation
An ambassador goes quiet	Monthly minimum written in, 90-day checkpoint, 30-day termination either way
Reputational exposure from tying the brand to an individual	Conduct clause in every agreement
No fitment for an ambassador's truck	Audit the eight vehicles against stock **before** anyone is signed
Capacity — one person running eight relationships	Start at eight. Expand mid-2027 only if the rhythm is holding

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Baseline figures referenced here come from the September 2026 diagnosis. Worth refreshing the follower and conversion numbers the morning of the meeting.

Supporting documents: `jackman-ambassador-program-design-2026-10-06-v1` *(full operating detail) and* `jackman-ambassador-master-priority-2026-10-06-v2.xlsx` *(all 59 accounts, scored).*